

GED Social Studies Practice Test 9

PART A — QUESTIONS

GED-SOC9-001

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution requires that legislative districts be reviewed after each census. If one district has grown much larger than another, lawmakers must adjust district lines so that representation remains based on current population. Courts may review whether the plan creates districts with seriously unequal populations.

Which civic principle is most directly supported by this process?

- A) Equal population representation
- B) Executive control of courts
- C) State power to sign treaties
- D) Hereditary selection of lawmakers

GED-SOC9-002

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows average hourly wages in one industry.

Year: 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023

Average hourly wage: \$19, \$20, \$22, \$24

Which conclusion is best supported by the data?

- A) Average hourly wages increased over the period.
- B) Average hourly wages decreased every year.
- C) Average hourly wages stayed at \$19.
- D) Average hourly wages doubled between 2020 and 2023.

GED-SOC9-003

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In 1798, the federal government passed laws that made it easier to deport noncitizens and punished certain criticism of the government. Supporters argued that the laws protected national security during conflict with a foreign power. Critics argued that the laws violated freedom of speech and gave the federal government too much power.

Which issue was central to this debate?

- A) The tension between national security and civil liberties
- B) The creation of the first public school system
- C) The debate over western railroad construction
- D) The decision to admit Alaska as a state

GED-SOC9-004

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country has a long coastline with many natural harbors. Fishing, ship repair, tourism, and international shipping are major economic activities. Inland regions are more focused on livestock and grain farming.

Which statement best explains the regional pattern?

- A) Physical location can influence the types of economic activities that develop.
- B) Coastal regions cannot participate in international trade.
- C) Inland regions always depend on ship repair.
- D) Harbors have no connection to economic activity.

GED-SOC9-005

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state requires each agency to write regulations only within the authority given to it by statute. If an agency writes a rule beyond that authority, a court may invalidate the rule.

Which TWO statements best explain the civic purpose of this system?

- A) Agencies must remain within legal authority granted by elected lawmakers.
- B) Courts can help enforce legal limits on administrative action.
- C) Agencies may create any rule they want without lawmaking authority.
- D) Courts must approve every private business decision.
- E) State agencies can replace the legislature permanently.

GED-SOC9-006

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Paired sources:

Source A:

A mayor argues that public health rules should be set city by city because population density, transportation patterns, and local hospital capacity differ. The mayor says local officials can respond quickly to neighborhood conditions.

Source B:

A state health director argues that statewide public health standards prevent confusion and make sure residents receive similar protections no matter where they live. The director says local differences matter, but minimum standards should apply everywhere in the state.

What is the main disagreement between the two sources?

- A) Whether public health rules should be mainly local or statewide
- B) Whether hospitals should be replaced by courts
- C) Whether city governments should appoint state legislators
- D) Whether residents should be banned from receiving health information

GED-SOC9-007

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

During the early republic, political leaders disagreed over foreign relations. Some favored closer ties with Britain because of trade and stability. Others favored France because of its revolution and earlier support for American independence. These disagreements helped shape early political parties.

Which conclusion is best supported by the source?

- A) Foreign policy disagreements contributed to the growth of political parties.
- B) Early political leaders agreed on all foreign policy questions.
- C) The United States had no trade connections with Europe.
- D) Political parties disappeared after the American Revolution.

GED-SOC9-008

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

The constitutional requirement that government may not take private property for public use without fair payment is known as [D1] and is connected to [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) just compensation | naturalization | cloture

D2) eminent domain limits | presidential succession | foreign recognition

GED-SOC9-009

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state minimum wage increased from \$12 per hour to \$15 per hour. What was the percent increase?

Type your answer as a whole number percent without the percent sign.

GED-SOC9-010

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A country is located along a major earthquake zone where two tectonic plates meet. Many cities use building codes that require stronger foundations and flexible materials. Older buildings that do not meet the standards are more likely to be damaged during earthquakes.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) Natural hazards can influence construction rules and urban planning.
- B) Earthquake risk has no relationship to building design.
- C) Cities cannot exist near tectonic plate boundaries.
- D) Building codes are used only in areas with no natural hazards.

GED-SOC9-011

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

Congress passes a law allowing federal agencies to set technical safety standards for passenger airplanes. The law also requires agencies to explain their standards and allows courts to review whether the agencies acted within the law.

Which statement best explains this arrangement?

- A) Congress may delegate technical rulemaking while keeping agencies subject to legal review.
- B) Agencies may act without any authority from Congress.
- C) Courts may not review agency action under any circumstances.
- D) Passenger safety rules can be created only by private companies.

GED-SOC9-012

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows miles of canals in one state.

Year: 1825, 1845, 1865

Canal miles: 360, 910, 1,240

Which statement is best supported by the data?

- A) Canal mileage increased from 1825 to 1865.
- B) Canal mileage decreased after 1825.
- C) Canal mileage was highest in 1825.
- D) Canal mileage stayed exactly the same.

GED-SOC9-013

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

The Constitution lists specific qualifications for members of the House of Representatives. A representative must meet age, citizenship, and residency requirements. States may not add extra qualifications that conflict with the Constitution.

Which statement best describes the purpose of these rules?

- A) They establish national eligibility standards for serving in the House.
- B) They allow state governors to appoint all House members.
- C) They give courts power to cancel congressional elections.
- D) They require every representative to serve for life.

GED-SOC9-014

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A city places a tax on hotel rooms. City officials say the tax will help pay for tourism services such as visitor centers and convention planning. Hotel owners argue that higher room costs may discourage some travelers.

Which conclusion is best supported by this scenario?

- A) A tax can raise public revenue while also changing consumer costs.
- B) Taxes never affect prices paid by consumers.
- C) Hotel taxes can be used only by private businesses.
- D) Tourism services cannot be funded by local government.

GED-SOC9-015

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A legislature creates an independent inspector general's office to investigate waste, fraud, and abuse inside state agencies. The office may recommend corrective action but must send criminal allegations to prosecutors.

Which statement best describes the role of the inspector general?

- A) It investigates misconduct and helps improve government operations.
- B) It replaces courts by sentencing people to prison.
- C) It allows agencies to spend money without review.
- D) It gives private companies power to veto state laws.

GED-SOC9-016

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

During the 1890s, the United States experienced a severe economic depression. Banks failed, businesses closed, and unemployment rose. Some workers joined protest movements demanding relief, while political leaders debated currency policy and the role of government in stabilizing the economy.

Which TWO conclusions are best supported by this description?

- A) Economic downturns can lead to political pressure for government action.
- B) Financial crises can affect employment and business activity.
- C) Economic depressions always eliminate political debate.
- D) Workers had no response to unemployment.
- E) Currency policy was unrelated to economic concerns.

GED-SOC9-017

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A region reports annual rainfall by area.

Area: Coast, Plateau, Mountain slope, Interior basin

Annual rainfall: 48 inches, 22 inches, 36 inches, 11 inches

Which area receives the least annual rainfall?

- A) Coast
- B) Plateau
- C) Mountain slope
- D) Interior basin

GED-SOC9-018

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A city creates a civilian review board to examine complaints about police conduct. The board may recommend policy changes and refer serious findings to appropriate disciplinary authorities, but it does not conduct criminal trials.

Which civic goal is most directly connected to this board?

- A) Oversight of public officials and agencies
- B) Replacement of elected government with military rule
- C) Elimination of all law enforcement
- D) Private control of court sentencing

GED-SOC9-019

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A small country reports annual exports and imports.

Year: 2023

Exports: \$42 billion

Imports: \$50 billion

Which statement best describes the country's trade balance for 2023?

- A) It had a trade deficit of \$8 billion.
- B) It had a trade surplus of \$8 billion.
- C) It had a trade surplus of \$92 billion.
- D) Its exports and imports were equal.

GED-SOC9-020

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

The Constitution gives the Senate the power to approve or reject certain presidential appointments. This is an example of [D1] because it allows [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) advice and consent | eminent domain | naturalization

D2) one branch to limit another branch | states to coin money | courts to declare war

GED-SOC9-021

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state legislature has 120 members. A bill passes with 78 votes in favor.

What percent of members voted in favor?

- A) 55%
- B) 60%
- C) 65%
- D) 78%

GED-SOC9-022

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A city charter allows residents to request a recall election if they collect signatures from 20% of registered voters. A recall election lets voters decide whether an elected official should be removed before the end of the term.

Which statement best describes this process?

- A) It gives voters a method to remove an elected official before the next regular election.
- B) It allows judges to appoint city council members for life.
- C) It gives the mayor power to cancel election results.
- D) It replaces voting with private arbitration.

GED-SOC9-023

Section: Social Studies

Type: numeric_entry

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A metropolitan area had 2,400,000 residents in 2010 and 2,760,000 residents in 2020. What was the percent increase?

Type your answer as a whole number percent without the percent sign.

GED-SOC9-024

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Source:

In the 1910s, many African Americans left Southern states for Northern and Midwestern cities.

They sought industrial jobs, better schools, and greater personal safety. They also left areas where segregation and racial violence limited opportunity.

Which historical pattern is described?

- A) The Great Migration and its push-pull factors
- B) The California Gold Rush and its mining camps
- C) The creation of the first national bank
- D) The expansion of Spanish missions in the Southwest

GED-SOC9-025

Section: Social Studies

Type: drag_drop

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

Match each target with the correct tile.

Tiles:

- A) Inspector general
- B) Recall
- C) Advice and consent
- D) Statutory authority

Targets:

T1) Legal power given by a law passed by the legislature

- T2) Senate approval or rejection of certain presidential appointments
- T3) A process that may remove an elected official before the term ends

GED-SOC9-026

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Economics

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A government report says that inflation has reduced purchasing power. A family's income stayed the same, but food, rent, and transportation cost more than they did last year.

Which statement best explains the effect described?

- A) The same income buys fewer goods and services when prices rise.
- B) Inflation means prices always fall.
- C) Purchasing power increases when costs rise faster than income.
- D) Inflation has no effect on household budgets.

GED-SOC9-027

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A state requires that public schools provide equal educational services to students regardless of citizenship status. State officials say children living in the state should not be denied basic public education because of their immigration status.

Which civic principle is most closely connected to this policy?

- A) Equal protection in access to public services
- B) The power of states to conduct foreign wars
- C) The right of cities to coin money
- D) Legislative punishment without trial

GED-SOC9-028

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Analyzing Historical Events and Arguments

Prompt:

A court reviews a law that limits campaign contributions. Supporters say the limits reduce corruption or the appearance of corruption. Opponents say the limits restrict political expression and association.

Which constitutional issue is most directly involved?

- A) Balancing campaign finance regulation with First Amendment interests
- B) Deciding whether states may sign treaties
- C) Determining how soldiers are quartered in private homes
- D) Choosing the number of cabinet departments

GED-SOC9-029

Section: Social Studies

Type: dropdown

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

During the Vietnam War era, many Americans debated whether citizens should be drafted into military service. The debate raised questions about [D1] and [D2].

Dropdowns:

D1) individual rights and civic obligations | colonial mercantilism | western land surveys

D2) the power of government during wartime | cotton production quotas | early canal construction

GED-SOC9-030

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A city needs 12,000 valid signatures to place a recall question on the ballot. Organizers submit 14,500 signatures, and election officials reject 1,900 as invalid.

How many valid signatures remain?

A) 10,600

B) 12,000

C) 12,600

D) 14,500

GED-SOC9-031

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state ethics rule prohibits former high-ranking officials from lobbying the agencies they once led for one year after leaving office. Supporters say the rule helps prevent officials from using recent government positions for immediate private advantage.

Which claim is best supported by the source?

A) Cooling-off periods can reduce conflicts between public service and private gain.

B) Former officials may never work in private employment.

C) Ethics rules are designed to increase secret influence.

D) Lobbying is the same as voting in a legislature.

GED-SOC9-032

Section: Social Studies

Type: multi_select

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

Select TWO answers.

A state reports voter registration by affiliation.

Affiliation: Party A, Party B, No party, Other

Registered voters: 2,400,000, 2,100,000, 1,500,000, 300,000

Which TWO statements are supported by the data?

- A) Party A has the largest number of registered voters.
- B) Other has the smallest number of registered voters.
- C) No party has more registered voters than Party B.
- D) Party B and Other together total 3,000,000 voters.
- E) Party A has fewer registered voters than No party.

GED-SOC9-033

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Geography and the World

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

A country's capital city is located far from several remote northern communities. During winter, some roads are closed for weeks because of snow and ice. The government uses small airports and seasonal supply routes to deliver medicine, fuel, and food.

Which geographic challenge is most clearly described?

- A) Distance and climate can make transportation and service delivery difficult.
- B) Remote communities never need public services.
- C) Winter weather improves road access in all regions.
- D) Air transport is used only for international trade.

GED-SOC9-034

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: U.S. History

Skill: Using Numbers and Graphs in Social Studies

Prompt:

A table shows U.S. television ownership.

Year: 1950, 1960, 1970

Households with televisions: 9%, 87%, 95%

Which statement is best supported by the table?

- A) Television ownership expanded rapidly between 1950 and 1970.
- B) Television ownership decreased after 1950.
- C) Television ownership was highest in 1950.
- D) Fewer than 10% of households had televisions in 1970.

GED-SOC9-035

Section: Social Studies

Type: mcq

Category: Civics and Government

Skill: Reading for Meaning in Social Studies

Prompt:

Source:

A state constitution says that each law must apply generally and may not grant special privileges to a single person or company unless there is a valid public purpose. Courts use this rule to prevent arbitrary favoritism in lawmaking.

Which claim is best supported by the source?

- A) Laws should avoid unfair special treatment without a legitimate public reason.
- B) Legislatures must give special privileges to one company in every law.
- C) Courts cannot review whether laws are arbitrary.
- D) Public purpose is unrelated to lawmaking.

PART B — ANSWER KEY + EXPLANATIONS

GED-SOC9-001 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Equal population representation — Explanation: Reviewing districts after the census helps keep representation based on current population.

GED-SOC9-002 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Average hourly wages increased over the period. — Explanation: Wages rose from \$19 to \$24 between 2020 and 2023.

GED-SOC9-003 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The tension between national security and civil liberties — Explanation: The source describes laws defended as security measures but criticized for limiting speech and expanding federal power.

GED-SOC9-004 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Physical location can influence the types of economic activities that develop. — Explanation: Coastal harbors support maritime activities, while inland regions focus more on farming.

GED-SOC9-005 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Agencies must remain within legal authority granted by elected lawmakers. | Courts can help enforce legal limits on administrative action. — Explanation: Agencies need statutory authority, and courts can invalidate rules that exceed it.

GED-SOC9-006 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Whether public health rules should be mainly local or statewide — Explanation: Source A favors local control, while Source B supports statewide minimum standards.

GED-SOC9-007 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Foreign policy disagreements contributed to the growth of political parties. — Explanation: The source connects disagreements over Britain and France to early party formation.

GED-SOC9-008 — Correct: D1=just compensation; D2=eminent domain limits — Correct Answer: D1=just compensation; D2=eminent domain limits — Explanation: Eminent domain allows taking property for public use only with fair payment and legal limits.

GED-SOC9-009 — Correct: 25 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 25 — Explanation: The increase is \$3; \$3 divided by \$12 equals 25%.

GED-SOC9-010 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Natural hazards can influence construction rules and urban planning. — Explanation: Earthquake risk leads cities to require stronger building designs.

GED-SOC9-011 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Congress may delegate technical rulemaking while keeping agencies subject to legal review. — Explanation: Agencies can set technical standards under laws passed by Congress, and courts can review their actions.

GED-SOC9-012 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Canal mileage increased from 1825 to 1865. — Explanation: Canal mileage rose from 360 to 1,240 miles.

GED-SOC9-013 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: They establish national eligibility standards for serving in the House. — Explanation: The Constitution sets qualifications that states cannot contradict.

GED-SOC9-014 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: A tax can raise public revenue while also changing consumer costs. — Explanation: The hotel tax funds public services but may raise room costs for travelers.

GED-SOC9-015 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: It investigates misconduct and helps improve government operations. — Explanation: An inspector general investigates waste, fraud, and abuse and recommends corrective action.

GED-SOC9-016 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Economic downturns can lead to political pressure for government action. | Financial crises can affect employment and business activity. — Explanation: The depression caused bank failures, business closures, unemployment, and political demands.

GED-SOC9-017 — Correct: D — Correct Answer: Interior basin — Explanation: The interior basin receives 11 inches, the lowest amount listed.

GED-SOC9-018 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Oversight of public officials and agencies — Explanation: A civilian review board examines complaints and recommends policy changes or referrals.

GED-SOC9-019 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: It had a trade deficit of \$8 billion. — Explanation: Imports exceeded exports by \$8 billion.

GED-SOC9-020 — Correct: D1=advice and consent; D2=one branch to limit another branch — Correct Answer: D1=advice and consent; D2=one branch to limit another branch — Explanation: Senate approval of appointments is the advice and consent role and checks presidential appointment power.

GED-SOC9-021 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 65% — Explanation: 78 out of 120 equals 65%.

GED-SOC9-022 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: It gives voters a method to remove an elected official before the next regular election. — Explanation: A recall election allows voters to decide whether to remove an official before the term ends.

GED-SOC9-023 — Correct: 15 — Tolerance: exact — Correct Answer: 15 — Explanation: The increase is 360,000; 360,000 divided by 2,400,000 equals 15%.

GED-SOC9-024 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The Great Migration and its push-pull factors — Explanation: African Americans left segregation and violence and moved toward jobs, schools, and safety.

GED-SOC9-025 — Correct: T1=D; T2=C; T3=B — Correct Answer: T1=Statutory authority; T2=Advice and consent; T3=Recall — Explanation: Statutory authority comes from law, advice and consent is Senate approval, and recall can remove an elected official.

GED-SOC9-026 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: The same income buys fewer goods and services when prices rise. — Explanation: Inflation reduces purchasing power when income does not rise with prices.

GED-SOC9-027 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Equal protection in access to public services — Explanation: The policy provides equal access to basic public education regardless of citizenship status.

GED-SOC9-028 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Balancing campaign finance regulation with First Amendment interests — Explanation: Campaign finance rules involve preventing corruption while also affecting political expression and association.

GED-SOC9-029 — Correct: D1=individual rights and civic obligations; D2=the power of government during wartime — Correct Answer: D1=individual rights and civic obligations; D2=the power of government during wartime — Explanation: Draft debates often involved personal liberty, civic duty, and government authority during war.

GED-SOC9-030 — Correct: C — Correct Answer: 12,600 — Explanation: 14,500 submitted signatures minus 1,900 invalid signatures equals 12,600 valid signatures.

GED-SOC9-031 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Cooling-off periods can reduce conflicts between public service and private gain. — Explanation: The rule prevents officials from immediately using former positions to influence agencies for private clients.

GED-SOC9-032 — Correct: A,B — Correct Answer: Party A has the largest number of registered voters. | Other has the smallest number of registered voters. — Explanation: Party A has the most voters at 2,400,000, while Other has the fewest at 300,000.

GED-SOC9-033 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Distance and climate can make transportation and service delivery difficult. — Explanation: Remote location and winter road closures make supplies and services harder to deliver.

GED-SOC9-034 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Television ownership expanded rapidly between 1950 and 1970. — Explanation: Television ownership increased from 9% to 95%.

GED-SOC9-035 — Correct: A — Correct Answer: Laws should avoid unfair special treatment without a legitimate public reason. — Explanation: The source describes a rule against arbitrary special privileges unless there is a valid public purpose.